Communicate. Collaborate. Succeed in the Workplace.

ENG3112

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By the end of this module, you will be able to:

- Recognize the importance of English in engineering workplaces
- Identify language barriers faced by interns
- Apply strategies to communicate confidently in professional contexts
- Use digital tools to improve workplace English

Raise your hand if:

- You feel confident speaking English in a workplace
- You feel *somewhat* confident
- You feel nervous speaking English at work

Importance of English in the workplace

- Communicating with:
  - Supervisors & engineers
  - Clients & vendors
  - International teams
- Key situations:
  - Meetings & briefings
  - Emails & reports
  - Presentations & interviews
  - Safety instructions

https://youtu.be/dsA_Cq40f1Y?si=ZwIOkW5RQju0yuCp

Reality Check: Internship & Industry Expectations

What companies expect from interns

- Basic professional communication
- Ability to:
  - Ask questions clearly
  - Explain problems
  - Follow instructions
- Confidence over perfection

💡 *Key message:*

"Good English ≠ perfect grammar"

Common challenges

- Fear of making mistakes
- Translating from Sinhala/Tamil
- Limited technical vocabulary
- Difficulty speaking in meetings
- Lack of confidence with seniors

Practical strategies

- Speak first, correct later
- Learn job-related vocabulary
- Practice short explanations
- Ask for clarification confidently
- Use simple, clear sentences

Confidence tips

- Preparation > perfection
- Body language & eye contact
- Polite professional phrases:
  - “Could you please explain…”
  - “In my opinion…”

    “I would like to clarify…”

Digital Tools to Improve English

Useful software & applications

- **Grammarly** – writing & emails
- **BBC Learning English** – listening & vocabulary
- **ELSA Speak** – pronunciation
- **YouTube** – engineering presentations
- **Google Translate**

Thank You